

# OBSCURE DERIVATIVES LIST

## A List of Challenging Latin Derivatives and Their Roots

### A

**acer:** eager, vinegar  
**acus:** eglantine  
**aemulus:** emulate  
**aes:** era  
**aestimo:** aim, esteem  
**aestus:** estuary  
**aevum:** age, eternity  
**ager:** pilgrim  
**ago:** agile, ambiguous, assay, essay, squat  
**aio:** adage  
**albus:** auburn, bedaub, daub  
**aliquis:** hidalgo  
**alter:** altruistic, adultery  
**altus:** exalt, haughty, oboe  
**amarus:** maraschino  
**ante:** advance, ancient, avaunt, vanguard  
**aperio:** overt, pert  
**aptus:** attitude, couple, lariat  
**aqua:** ewer, sewer  
**aquila:** eagle  
**arcus:** arcade  
**ars:** inert  
**as:** ace  
**asinus:** easel  
**audio:** obey  
**aurum:** oriole

### B

**battuo:** abate, battle, battery  
**bellum:** duel, rebel, revel  
**bibo:** beverage  
**bis:** balance, combine  
**bonus:** beau, bonbon, bounty  
**bos:** beef, bugle  
**bull:** bill, billet, boil, budge, bullet  
**buteo:** buzzard

### C

**caballus:** cavalier, cavalry, chivalry  
**cado:** chance, cheat  
**caedo:** cement, chisel  
**caleo:** caldron, calorie, chafe, chowder, nonchalant, scald, chauffeur

**calo**: conciliate, calendar, council, nomenclature  
**calvor**: calumny, challenge  
**calx**(heel): caulk/calk, cockatrice, inculcate, recalcitrant  
**calx**(small stone): calcium, calculate, chalk  
**campus**: campaign, champion  
**canis**: canary, canine, kennel  
**cano**: accent, charm, enchant, incentive  
**caper**: cab, taxicab  
**capio**: cable, caitiff, conceit, ketch, municipal, prince, recover  
**caput**: achieve, cabbage, capitol, cattle, chapter, chef, handkerchief, precipice  
**caro**: carnation, carnival, carrion  
**carpo**: carpet, scarce  
**carrus**: career, cargo, charge  
**casa**: casino  
**castra**: castle, chateau  
**castus**: castigate, chaste, incest  
**cauda**: caudal, coward, cue  
**causa**: accusative, because, excuse, kickshaw  
**cavea**: cage, decoy, jail  
**cedo**: cease, necessary  
**cerno**: decree, secret  
**cio**: citation, solicit  
**cilium**: supercilious  
**cingo**: cinch, succinct  
**circus**: search  
**civis**: citadel  
**clam**: clandestine  
**clamo**: claim  
**claudio**: cloister, seclude, sluice  
**cohors**: court, curtsy, courteous  
**collum**: accolade, collar  
**colo**: cult  
**contra**: counter, country  
**coquo**: apricot, biscuit, cuisine, terra-cotta  
**cor**: cordial, core, courage, record  
**corpus**: corps, corsage, corset  
**costa**: coast, cutlet, accost  
**crassus**: grease  
**cratis**: grate, grid, grill  
**credo**: grant, miscreant  
**cresco**: accrue, crew, increase, recruit  
**cubo**: concubine, covey, succumb  
**culina**: kiln  
**culus**: recoil  
**cuneus**: coin, cuneiform  
**cupio**: covet  
**cura**: assure, ensure, insure, proctor, proxy, scour

## D

**debeo:** devoir, endeavor

**decem:** dicker, dozen

**dens;** dandelion

**deus:** adieu

**dico(dicere):** ditty

**dies:** adjourn, dial, diary, dismal, journal, sojourn

**dignus:** dainty, deign, disdain

**do:** betray, dice, dowry, pardon, render, rendezvous, rent, traitor, treason, vendor

**domus:** bedlam, damsel, danger, dungeon, granny, madam, Madonna

**duo:** dozen, dual, duet

## E

**ebur:** ivory

**emo:** example, exempt, impromptu, premium, prompt, ransom, redeem, sample, vintage

**eo:** ambition, circuit, county, exit, issue, obituary, perish, praetorian, sudden, trance, viscount

**extra:** estrange, external, strange

**exsul:** exile

## F

**faber:** forge

**facio:** affair, chauffeur, defeat, façade, facet, feat

**fallo:** fail, fault

**fanum:** fanatic, profane

**fido:** affidavit, federal, fiancé

**filius:** affiliation, hidalgo

**filum:** profile

**tingo:** effigy, faint, feign, figure

**finis:** finesse, paraffin

**firmus:** farm

**fleo:** feeble, foible

**flo:** soufflé

**flos:** flour

**focus:** curfew, foyer, fuel

**folium:** foliage, portfolio

**for:** fable, fairy, fate, infant

**foris:** foreign, forest, forfeit

**formica:** chloroform, formaldehyde

**foro:** perforate

**forum:** forensic

**frango:** frail, fritter, osprey

**frater:** friar

**frenum:** refrain

**frigo:** fry

**frio:** friable

**fundo:** confuse, funnel, futile, foundry

**fur:** ferret, furtive

## G

**galbinus**: jaundice  
**gelu**: congeal, jelly  
**genus**: benign, engine, gent, germ, jaunty  
**gero**: jest, register  
**granum**: garnet, gravy, pomegranate  
**grus**: pedigree

## H

**habeo**: able, malady, provender  
**herba**: arbor  
**Hispania**: spaniel  
**hospes**: host, hotel, ostler

## I

**iaceo**: gist, joist  
**iacio**: jess, jet, jetty, jut  
**ieiunus**: dine, dinner  
**ilia**: jade  
**instauro**: store  
**insula**: isolation  
**inter**: enter, entrée  
**intus**: denizen  
**iocus**: jeopardy, jewel, juggle  
**iungo**: jostle, joust, juxtaposition  
**iuniperus**: gin(liquor)  
**ius(broth)**: juice  
**ius(right)**: justice  
**iuvo**: aid, coadjutor, jocund

## L

**labor(verb)**: avalanche, collapse  
**lac**: lettuce  
**lacertus**: alligator, lizard  
**lacus**: lagoon  
**lamina**: omelet  
**lancea**: launch  
**lassus**: alas  
**latus(adj.)**: dilate, latitude  
**latus(noun)**: lateral  
**latus(participle)**: elate, prelacy  
**laus**: allow  
**lavo**: deluge, launder, lava, lotion  
**laxus**: leash, release, relish  
**lego**: coil, cull, legion, lesson  
**levis**: carnival, leaven, levy  
**lex**: loyalty

**ligo:** alloy, ally, liaison, rally, rely

**locus:** couch, lieu, lieutenant

**longus:** lunge, purloin

## M

**macer:** emaciate, meager

**macula:** immaculate

**magis:** maestro, maxim, mayor

**mando:** commodore

**maneo:** manor, mansion, menial

**manus:** maintain, manacle, manure

**mappa:** apron, napkin

**mare:** cormorant, marinate, rosemary

**maturus:** demure

**mel:** molasses

**memini:** comment

**mensis:** semester

**merx:** market, merchant

**metus:** meticulous

**minae:** amenable, demeanor, promenade, promontory

**minuo:** menu, mince, minute

**misceo:** meddle, medley, melee, promiscuous

**mitto:** demise, mess, muss

**modus:** mold

**molo:** mill, molar

**moneo:** monitor, monster, monument, muster

**mordeo:** morsel

**mos:** morose

**moveo:** mob, moment, motif, mutiny

**mulgeo:** emulsion

**murus:** immure

**mus:** muscle, mussel

**musca:** mosquito, musketry

**muto:** molt

## N

**nascor:** naïve, puny

**necto:** annex, connect

**nego:** denial, renegade

**nepos:** nephew, niece

**niger:** daniel

**niteo:** neat, net

**noceo:** innocent, nuisance

**nomen:** ignominy, nominee, noun, renown

**non:** nonchalant, umpire

**nosco:** acquaint, connoisseur, notion

**novem:** noon

**nux:** nuclear

## O

**obliviscor:** oblivion  
**octo:** octave  
**oculus:** antler, eyelet, inveigle  
**odi:** annoy, ennui  
**operio:** cover, curfew, handkerchief  
**ops:** copy, office  
**opus:** inure, maneuver, manure  
**orbis:** exorbitant  
**orior:** aborigines, origin  
**oro:** adore, oracle, orison  
**os(ossis):** osprey

## P

**paene:** peninsula  
**palleo:** appall, pale  
**palus:** pole, travel  
**pando:** compass, expansive, pace, pass, passage, password, spawn  
**pango:** dispatch, impinge, propaganda  
**panis:** appanage, pannier, pantry  
**par:** pair, peer, umpire  
**parco:** parsimonious  
**pareo:** appear, apparition  
**pario:** repertoire  
**paro:** dissever, emperor, parapet, several  
**pars:** jeopardy, parcel, party  
**parvus:** paraffin  
**pax:** appease, pay  
**pectus:** parapet  
**pendeo:** append, appendage, pendant, pendulum, penthouse, propensity  
**pendo:** avoirdupois, expend, pansy, pension, pensive, poise, pound, stipend  
**penes:** penetrate  
**pes:** impeach, pawn, pedigree, pioneer, trivet, vamp  
**pila:** pellet, pill, platoon  
**pilus:** peel, pillage, plush  
**pinna:** pinnacle  
**piscis:** porpoise  
**placeo:** complaisant, placid, plea  
**plango:** complaint, plague, plaintiff  
**planus:** explain, piano, plan  
**plecto:** apply, display, employ, pleat, ply, supple  
**pomum:** pummel  
**pono:** depot, expound, provost  
**populus:** pueblo  
**porcus:** porcelain, porcupine, porpoise  
**porta:** porch, portico  
**porto:** porter, sport  
**post:** posthumous, puny  
**praeda:** prey

**prehendo:** apprentice, apprise, enterprise, entrepreneur, impresario, pry, prison, surprise

**premo:** print, reprimand, sprain

**pretium:** appraise, appreciate, price, prize

**prior:** premier, prince

**pulvis:** powder

**pungo:** poignant, point, puncture

**puppis:** poop

**puteus:** pit

**puto:** count

## Q

**quaero:** conquer

**quails:** kickshaw

**quatio:** cascara, cask, discuss, rescue, squash(verb)

**quattor:** quarantine, quarry, quire, squad

**quies:** acquit, coy, quit

**quinque:** quintessence

## R

**rabio:** rage

**racemus:** raisin

**rado:** erase, raze, razor

**rapio:** ravage, surreptitious, usurp

**ravis:** raucous

**rego:** address, adroit, alert, dress, rail, source, surge

**reor:** reason

**rex:** realm, viceroy

**rivus:** derivative, rival

**robur:** corroborate

**rodo:** erosion, rodent

**rota:** around, control, enroll, roll, roulette, round, rowel

**rumpo:** abrupt, route, routine

## S

**sacer:** sexton

**saepes:** transept

**sal:** salad, salary, sauce, sausage

**salio:** assail, exult, result, sally

**scamnum:** shambles

**scando:** scale

**scio:** nice

**scribo:** thrive

**scutum:** squire

**sedeo:** assess, assiduous, session, siege, size, surcease

**senex:** surly, seigneur

**sentio:** scent

**sequor:** ensue, intrinsic, lawsuit, obsequious, sect, set, sue

**sero(join together):** assert, desert, series

**sero**(sow): disseminate, season  
**servus**: dessert, sergeant  
**sine**: sans  
**sino**: site  
**sinus**: cosine  
**sol**: parasol  
**solidus**: soldier  
**solus**: sullen  
**soror**: cousin  
**specio**: spice, spite  
**spina**: porcupine  
**sterno**: stray, prostrate, street  
**sto**: arrest, cost, rest, stage, stay  
**stringo**: distress, prestige, strain, stress  
**struo**: construe, destroy  
**suavis**: assuage, suave  
**sum**: entity, possible, puissance  
**super**: soprano, sovereign  
**taceo**: reticent  
**tango**: attain, contagious, entire, integrate, taste  
**tempto**: tentacle  
**tempus**: tense  
**tendo**: portent, standard, tent  
**teneo**: abstain, rein, tennis, tenor  
**tergeo**: terse  
**tero**: contrite  
**texo**: subtle, tiller, tissue, toilet  
**tingo**: stain, tinge, tint  
**tono**: astonish, astound, stun, tornado  
**torqueo**: extort, torch, tormentor, torture  
**torreo**: toast, torrid  
**trabs**: architrave  
**traho**: entreat, portray, trace, treaty  
**tres**: travail, travel, treble  
**tuber**: truffle  
**tundo**: obtuse, toil  
**turba**: trouble

## U

**ultra**: outrage  
**uncia**: inch, ounce  
**unus**: onion, unit  
**uro**: combustion  
**utor**: peruse, usurp, utensil

## V

**vaco**: void



**vagina:** vanilla

**vannus:** fan

**veredus:** palfrey

**vestis:** travesty, vestry

**via:** convey, envoy, voyage

**vox:** avow, voice, vouch, vowel